the wilderness of the 5th XV to the brink of playing for the school's 1st XV, the celebrated Wit Bulle (White Bulls), so named in reference to our white jerseys and the Blue Bulls who played across the road at Loftus. The unthinkable had suddenly become possible.

Everything was going my way ... or so it seemed.

'AB, the head wants to see you in his office.'

What now?

Our headmaster was Dr Pierre Edwards, a former Northern Transvaal and Springbok fullback in his own right, and the expression on his face suggested this was not going to be a positive conversation.

'Please tell me about this radio station,' he said.

My heart sank.

'It was just a bit of fun, sir.'

'Did you say fun? I understand you and a few other boys have created a radio station broadcasting around 500 metres that is being listened to at the girls' school. Is that correct?'

I nodded.

'And I am told you have been speaking nonsense on this radio station.'

I nodded again, assuming he knew everything about our 'pirate radio', and confessed.

Two older boys had created the station and a group of us created the content, a mix of music and light-hearted interviews in which we spoke about how we were going to **** up Boys' High, for instance. Somebody also remarked on air that the daughter of one of the Affies teachers had exceptionally attractive legs. It was meant to be fun but, sitting in the head's office, it became clear we had crossed the line.

'This is unacceptable behaviour,' he concluded, 'and we will decide your punishment later.'

Six other boys from my year were called to see Dr Edwards about the radio station, and they successfully covered their tracks, persuading the head they had done nothing wrong. I became the fall guy.